

What's the best Lockscreen replacement app for your Android device?

How many times have you actually given a second thought about your lockscreen? There are tons of ways you can customise it to suit your needs, and we bring you the best of them.

Dhruv Kumar
readersletters@digit.in

The beauty of an operating system lies mainly in the effortlessness with which it amalgamates form and function. Android, known for its highly customisable nature, has left no stone unturned in handing over the reins of power to the user, which includes letting you change the lock screen. This particular feature lets you do everything right from replying to messages to taking pictures, provided you have the right settings and applications activated and installed, respectively.

With a plethora of useful lock screen replacement applications available out there, you might end up neglecting the need to unlock your phone for the entire day. You might even mistake a couple of them to be one of those home screen launchers. We take a brief look at a few of the more useful ones up for grabs.

1. Cover

This one's a very thoughtfully designed application that'll enable you to do almost everything that one would not generally expect from a lock screen. Of course, there are always two sides to the coin. One major drawback of this application is that you cannot lock your screen from unauthorised users. The option to secure the lockscreen with a passcode or pattern does not exist here.

The first look of the lock screen won't exactly grab your attention as it's just a simple background with a vertical dock of icons displayed towards the left of the

screen. The real magic starts when you hold on to an icon and swipe towards the right. The application opens up in the background, giving you a quick view of its home page, undoubtedly reminiscent of the Blackberry Hub-like feel of the not-so-long lasting Blackberry touch phones. That's not it; these icons in the vertical dock also change with time and location, along with the lock screen background. So you have timely access to the right apps.

Cover will also give you the power to switch between apps without having to actually unlock the screen, wiping out the need to unlock the device for regular usage. An intelligent lock screen replacement application that focuses more on usability and function rather than form; if you want to quickly peek into who messaged you last or check the latest score update from your sports application – all right on your lock screen – then hit the Play Store and look no further.

2. Echo Notification Lockscreen

Now here's a lock screen for those of us who don't like

pending notifications and also believe in attention to detail. Echo Notification Lockscreen, as the name suggests, has notifications as its base feature, which it displays

right up front with detailed information. What makes it stand out from your regular lock screen apps is that all the notifications are in-depth, expanded and separate. This means, each of your WhatsApp messages will be shown as an individual notification on the lock screen rather than the usual '3 new messages'.

What's more, you can tap the notification to open it right on your lock screen and even long press to snooze it and be reminded again at a later time – a highly useful element. The notifications can also be manually classified into groups like Priority and Social for a better organised view. For securing your device you have the ability to set a pattern lock.

Once again a must-have if you want most of your work to be done quickly, by checking your notifications.

3. Go Locker

This one's for the customisation-junkies. It won't be hyperbole to say that this lock screen replacement is



App Glance on Cover



Neat 'Echo Lockscreen'